

If Windows were a game franchise, then Windows 10 would be like that reboot that drops all sub-titles and numbers. Windows is now simply 'Windows 10' and it is that product that will receive constant upgrades.

There is a comparison to be made with Apple's Mac OS. Before Mac OS X, there once was 'Mac OS 9'. Ever since the release of Mac OS X though, Apple has been releasing major new operating system releases under the OS X name. In fact with the release of OS X Mountain Lion or 10.7 Apple dropped the 'Mac' and called it simply 'OS X'.

Much like the OS X of today is wildly different from the initial Mac OS X release nearly 14 years ago. Windows 10 might easily still be called Windows 10 in another 14 years, but it will likely be a completely different OS.



While there are definite similarities between the OS X of today, and Mac OS X when it launched, it's still come a very long way.

Where Microsoft's approach differs from that of Apple is that Microsoft is also changing its release strategy. In previous versions of Windows, updates would generally only fix things, bugs, security, performance etc. Once there were enough updates they would be bundled together as a Service Pack. This was supposed to be devoid of any new features, but Windows XP SP2 famously bucked this trend. Likewise Windows 8.1 too brought significant changes.